

BLACK KNIGHT

Knight of the Ebony Blade

The first Black Knight, Sir Percy of Scandia, was born in the 6th Century and became one of the bravest knights at the court of King Arthur PENDRAGON at Camelot. Here he led a double life, posing as a mild-mannered fop while secretly fighting evil as the Black Knight, armed with the Ebony Blade, a sword fashioned by MERLIN the Magician from the Starstone meteorite. Centuries later, Sir Percy's spirit returned to converse with his ancestors, Professor Nathan Garrett and Dane Whitman, each of whom would take up his mantle.



Raised in Scandinavia, Sir Percy was a new face to the people of Camelot.

VILLAINOUS KNIGHT

Nathan Garrett met the spirit of Sir Percy during a visit to the family home of Garrett Castle, and was offered the chance to become a latter-day Black Knight. However, Garrett failed to draw the Ebony Blade from its scabbard thereby proving himself unworthy. Determined to become the Black Knight by other means, Garrett developed a lance that fired energy bolts, and embarked on a criminal career mounted upon a genetically engineered winged horse. Garrett battled the Avengers with the MASTERS OF EVIL, dying in a fight with IRON MAN. Before passing away, Garrett confessed his crimes to his nephew, Dane Whitman, and begged him to restore his honor.

A brilliant scientist, Garrett used his knowledge to create a winged steed.

THE GOOD KNIGHT

Initially mistaken as the previous Black Knight and attacked by the AVENGERS, Dane Whitman soon gained their trust and joined the team. Blessed with a noble spirit, he was able to draw the Ebony Blade once wielded by his ancestor Sir Percy. Unfortunately, the sword had been cursed with the blood of those felled by Sir Percy. This curse dogged Whitman for years until DOCTOR STRANGE finally recognized what it was. In order to cleanse it, Whitman was instructed to plunge the sword into the Brazier of Truth, located in Garrett Castle. Whitman's effort shattered the Brazier. Since it was this mystical object that held Sir Percy's spirit in this world, its destruction finally allowed him to rest. Dane joined CAPTAIN BRITAIN in MI-13 during the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7) taking on the new hero, Faiza Hussain, as his squire while protecting Britain from the SKRULLS. **AD, MF**



The dark sorcerer Kalmari battled Dane Whitman with a dragon, but this version of the Black Knight proved victorious.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **The Black Knight #1-3** Sir Percy begins his adventures as the Black Knight.
- **Avengers Vol. 1 #71** Dane Whitman helps the Avengers beat Kang and becomes a member.
- **Dr. Strange Vol. 2 #68** Whitman cleanses the Ebony Blade of evil and frees Sir Percy's ghost.

The Ebony Blade renders its user invulnerable but, if it tastes blood, will eventually corrupt him.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Dane Whitman

OCCUPATION

Adventurer

BASE

New York City

HEIGHT

6 ft

WEIGHT

190 lbs

EYES

Brown

HAIR

Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Avengers Vol. 1 #47
(December 1967)

An able scientist, Whitman built on discoveries of his uncle, Nathan Garrett; rides a winged horse and has power lance that fires heat and force beams; also wields Ebony Blade, sometimes more curse than blessing.

BLACK KNIGHT

POWERS

